

Narration scripts

One script for each of the 47 questions, for the play button on “Today’s Question”. Each runs about two minutes at a calm pace (140 words a minute); all of them together come to about 90 minutes.

Paste one script at a time into the text-to-speech tool: everything below the grey “Audio file” line, from “Today’s Question” to the end of the page. The same text is in **tools/guidance/narration/text/** as one plain-text file per question, which pastes more cleanly than a PDF. Save each recording under the file name shown, so the page can find it by the question's id. Scripture is the King James Version, word for word, with LORD written as Lord so the voice does not spell it out.

#	Question	Audio file	Words	Time
1	What do I do when I can't stop worrying?	worry-and-anxiety.webm	294	2:06
2	How can I be brave when I'm afraid?	fear-and-courage.webm	242	1:44
3	What do I do with my anger?	anger.webm	240	1:43
4	How do I stay humble?	pride-and-humility.webm	211	1:30
5	Why am I never satisfied?	contentment.webm	267	1:54
6	How do I say no to temptation?	temptation.webm	237	1:42
7	Does God care what I think about and do with my body?	purity.webm	251	1:48
8	Do I really matter to God?	self-worth.webm	292	2:05
9	What does real love look like?	love.webm	308	2:12
10	How can I forgive someone who hurt me?	forgiveness.webm	287	2:03
11	What does God say about marriage?	marriage.webm	214	1:32
12	How should families treat each other?	parents-and-children.webm	253	1:48
13	What makes a true friend?	friendship.webm	244	1:45
14	How do I treat people who are against me?	loving-your-enemies.webm	269	1:55
15	Do my words really matter?	words-and-the-tongue.webm	254	1:49
16	Is being single second best?	singleness.webm	328	2:21
17	Does my work matter to God?	work.webm	247	1:46
18	How should I think about money?	money-and-posessions.webm	299	2:08
19	How much should I give?	generosity.webm	241	1:43
20	Is a small lie really a big deal?	honesty.webm	215	1:32
21	What does God expect me to do about injustice?	justice-and-the-poor.webm	259	1:51
22	Is it wrong to be in debt?	debt-and-borrowing.webm	245	1:45
23	What is my life for?	purpose.webm	235	1:41
24	How should I pray?	prayer.webm	225	1:36
25	How can I trust God when I can't see the way?	faith-and-trust.webm	296	2:07
26	How do I know what God wants me to do?	knowing-god-s-will.webm	234	1:40
27	Is it all right to stop?	rest.webm	277	1:59
28	What does it mean to be great?	serving-others.webm	277	1:59
29	How can I be right with God?	salvation.webm	309	2:12
30	Why should I read the Bible?	reading-the-bible.webm	286	2:03
31	Do I need a church?	church-and-fellowship.webm	225	1:36
32	How can I be thankful when life is hard?	thankfulness.webm	276	1:58

#	Question	Audio file	Words	Time
33	Why is this happening to me?	suffering.webm	262	1:52
34	How do I grieve as a believer?	grief-and-loss.webm	241	1:43
35	What do I do when I feel like giving up?	discouragement-and-doubt.webm	246	1:45
36	What if I feel completely alone?	loneliness.webm	267	1:54
37	Where is God when I'm sick?	sickness-and-healing.webm	346	2:28
38	Can God forgive what I've done?	guilt-and-shame.webm	328	2:21
39	Can I start again after I've failed?	failure.webm	301	2:09
40	Why is God taking so long?	waiting.webm	273	1:57
41	What if people mock me for my faith?	standing-for-your-faith.webm	330	2:21
42	Is there hope for my future?	hope.webm	247	1:46
43	What does God say about growing old?	growing-old.webm	284	2:02
44	What happens when we die?	death-and-eternal-life.webm	284	2:02
45	Is Jesus really coming back?	the-return-of-christ.webm	327	2:20
46	Will I have to answer for my life?	judgement.webm	307	2:12
47	How does the story end?	all-things-new.webm	230	1:39

Worry and anxiety

Audio file: worry-and-anxiety.webm · 294 words · about 2:06

Today's Question. What do I do when I can't stop worrying?

Worry pulls tomorrow's troubles into today. Scripture's answer is not to stop caring, but to hand the care to God.

Jesus does not tell worried people to try harder. He points them to a Father who feeds the birds and knows what they need, and tells them to put his kingdom first and take one day at a time. The apostles turn that into a habit: bring every care to God in prayer, with thanks, and his peace will guard your heart and mind.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 6, verses 33 and 34: But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you. Take therefore no thought for the morrow: for the morrow shall take thought for the things of itself. Sufficient unto the day is the evil thereof.

And in Philippians chapter 4, verses 6 and 7: Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God. And the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.

And in Psalm 55, verse 22: Cast thy burden upon the Lord, and he shall sustain thee: he shall never suffer the righteous to be moved.

Here is one thing to try. When a worry comes, turn it into a one-line prayer, then name one thing you are thankful for.

Let us pray. Father, you know what I need before I ask. I give you what I am carrying today, and I trust you with tomorrow. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Fear and courage

Audio file: fear-and-courage.webm · 242 words · about 1:44

Today's Question. How can I be brave when I'm afraid?

Courage in the Bible is not the absence of fear. It is trusting that God is with you in it.

'Fear not' is one of the most repeated commands in Scripture, and it almost always comes with a reason: 'for I am with thee'. God does not ask his people to feel strong. He asks them to remember who goes with them, and to take the next step.

The Bible says, in John chapter 14, verse 27: Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you: not as the world giveth, give I unto you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.

And in Psalm 27, verse 1: The Lord is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear? the Lord is the strength of my life; of whom shall I be afraid?

And in Second Timothy chapter 1, verse 7: For God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.

Here is one thing to try. Name the fear out loud, then say who is with you in it. Take one small step anyway.

Let us pray. Lord, I am afraid. Remind me that you are with me, and give me courage for the next step. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Anger

Audio file: anger.webm · 240 words · about 1:43

Today's Question. What do I do with my anger?

Anger is not always sin, but it must not be kept, fed or acted on in revenge.

The Bible expects us to feel anger and warns us not to let it rule. Deal with it quickly, before the day ends; listen more than you speak; answer softly. Jesus takes it further: if someone has something against you, go and make peace before you go to worship.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 5, verses 23 and 24: Therefore if thou bring thy gift to the altar, and there rememberest that thy brother hath ought against thee; Leave there thy gift before the altar, and go thy way; first be reconciled to thy brother, and then come and offer thy gift.

And in Ephesians chapter 4, verses 26 and 27: Be ye angry, and sin not: let not the sun go down upon your wrath: Neither give place to the devil.

And in Proverbs chapter 15, verse 1: A soft answer turneth away wrath: but grievous words stir up anger.

Here is one thing to try. Before you answer in anger, wait, and ask God's question: 'Doest thou well to be angry?'

Let us pray. Lord, slow me down. Help me to listen before I speak, and to make peace before the sun goes down. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Pride and humility

Audio file: pride-and-humility.webm · 211 words · about 1:30

Today's Question. How do I stay humble?

Pride puts self at the centre. Humility is not thinking less of yourself, but thinking of others and of God first.

Scripture turns the world's ladder upside down: the one who lifts himself up is brought down, and the one who humbles himself is lifted up. Humility is walking with God and counting other people's needs as important as your own.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 14, verse 11: For whosoever exalteth himself shall be abased; and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted.

And in Proverbs chapter 16, verse 18: Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall.

And in Philippians chapter 2, verses 3 and 4: Let nothing be done through strife or vainglory; but in lowliness of mind let each esteem other better than themselves. Look not every man on his own things, but every man also on the things of others.

Here is one thing to try. Today, quietly do something for someone that no one will thank you for.

Let us pray. Lord, keep me low before you. Teach me to walk humbly and to put others first. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Contentment

Audio file: contentment.webm · 267 words · about 1:54

Today's Question. Why am I never satisfied?

Contentment is learned, not bought. It grows from knowing that God will never leave you.

The Bible is blunt that more money and more things do not satisfy. Paul says he had to learn contentment, in plenty and in need, and that the secret was Christ's strength.

Hebrews gives the reason we can be content: God has promised never to leave us.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 12, verse 15: And he said unto them, Take heed, and beware of covetousness: for a man's life consisteth not in the abundance of the things which he possesseth.

And in Philippians chapter 4, verses 11 to 13: Not that I speak in respect of want: for I have learned, in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content. I know both how to be abased, and I know how to abound: every where and in all things I am instructed both to be full and to be hungry, both to abound and to suffer need. I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me.

And in Ecclesiastes chapter 5, verse 10: He that loveth silver shall not be satisfied with silver; nor he that loveth abundance with increase: this is also vanity.

Here is one thing to try. Write down three things you already have that you once prayed for.

Let us pray. Lord, you are enough for me. Teach me to be content, and to trust you in plenty and in need. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Temptation

Audio file: temptation.webm · 237 words · about 1:42

Today's Question. How do I say no to temptation?

Temptation comes to everyone. God always provides a way out, and his word is the first weapon.

Jesus was tempted and answered each time with Scripture. He told his friends to watch and pray, because the spirit is willing but the flesh is weak. The apostles add that no temptation is unique and that God always makes a way of escape; Joseph shows what taking it looks like.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 26, verse 41: Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation: the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.

And in First Corinthians chapter 10, verse 13: There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man: but God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it.

And in Proverbs chapter 4, verse 23: Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.

Here is one thing to try. Know your weak moment, and plan your way out before it comes.

Let us pray. Lead me not into temptation, Lord, and show me the way out when it comes. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Purity

Audio file: purity.webm · 251 words · about 1:48

Today's Question. Does God care what I think about and do with my body?

Yes. Purity starts in the heart and the thought life, and the body is a temple of the Holy Spirit.

Jesus blessed the pure in heart, because they will see God. The Bible treats the body as precious, bought at a price, and asks us to honour God with it. The way to a clean life is to fill the mind with what is true, lovely and good, and to keep to God's word.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 5, verse 8: Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.

And in Psalm 119, verse 9: Wherewithal shall a young man cleanse his way? by taking heed thereto according to thy word.

And in First Corinthians chapter 6, verses 19 and 20: What? know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own? For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's.

Here is one thing to try. Notice what you feed your eyes and mind on this week, and swap one thing for something good.

Let us pray. Create in me a clean heart, O God. Help me to honour you with my mind and body. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Self-worth

Audio file: self-worth.webm · 292 words · about 2:05

Today's Question. Do I really matter to God?

More than you know. God made you, knows you by name, and loved you before you did anything to earn it.

The world measures people by looks, money and success. God measures differently: he looks on the heart. Jesus said that not one sparrow falls without the Father, and that the very hairs of your head are numbered. The prophets heard God call his people by name and say 'thou art mine', and the apostles say we are his workmanship, loved enough to be called the sons of God.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 10, verses 29 to 31: Are not two sparrows sold for a farthing? and one of them shall not fall on the ground without your Father. But the very hairs of your head are all numbered. Fear ye not therefore, ye are of more value than many sparrows.

And in Psalm 139, verses 13 and 14: For thou hast possessed my reins: thou hast covered me in my mother's womb. I will praise thee; for I am fearfully and wonderfully made: marvellous are thy works; and that my soul knoweth right well.

And in Ephesians chapter 2, verse 10: For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them.

Here is one thing to try. When a voice inside tells you that you are worthless, answer it out loud: 'I am fearfully and wonderfully made'.

Let us pray. Father, thank you that you made me and know me by name. Help me to see myself as you see me. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Love

Audio file: love.webm · 308 words · about 2:12

Today's Question. What does real love look like?

Love God with everything, and love your neighbour as yourself. Everything else hangs on these two.

When asked for the greatest commandment, Jesus joined two from the Law: love God, love your neighbour. At the Last Supper he gave a new standard: love one another as I have loved you. Paul spells out what that love looks like day to day, and John says it comes from God, because God is love.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 22, verses 37 to 39: Jesus said unto him, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind. This is the first and great commandment. And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

And in First Corinthians chapter 13, verses 4 to 7: Charity suffereth long, and is kind; charity envieth not; charity vaunteth not itself, is not puffed up, Doth not behave itself unseemly, seeketh not her own, is not easily provoked, thinketh no evil; Rejoiceth not in iniquity, but rejoiceth in the truth; Beareth all things, believeth all things, hopeth all things, endureth all things.

And in Leviticus chapter 19, verse 18: Thou shalt not avenge, nor bear any grudge against the children of thy people, but thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself: I am the Lord.

Here is one thing to try. Read First Corinthians chapter 13, verses 4 to 7 and put your own name in place of 'charity'. Where does it not fit yet?

Let us pray. Lord, you loved me first. Teach me to love you with all I am, and to love the people around me as you do. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Forgiveness

Audio file: forgiveness.webm · 287 words · about 2:03

Today's Question. How can I forgive someone who hurt me?

We forgive because we have been forgiven. It is not pretending the hurt never happened, but letting God be the judge.

Jesus links our forgiving to our being forgiven, and told Peter to forgive without counting. On the cross he prayed for the men who crucified him. Forgiveness does not say the wrong was small; Joseph named what his brothers did as evil, and still left the judging to God and cared for them.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 6, verses 14 and 15: For if ye forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you: But if ye forgive not men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.

And in Ephesians chapter 4, verse 32: And be ye kind one to another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, even as God for Christ's sake hath forgiven you.

And in Micah chapter 7, verses 18 and 19: Who is a God like unto thee, that pardoneth iniquity, and passeth by the transgression of the remnant of his heritage? he retaineth not his anger for ever, because he delighteth in mercy. He will turn again, he will have compassion upon us; he will subdue our iniquities; and thou wilt cast all their sins into the depths of the sea.

Here is one thing to try. Name the person. Tell God honestly what they did, then ask him for the strength to release them.

Let us pray. Father, forgive me as I forgive those who have wronged me. Give me grace to let go of what I cannot carry. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Marriage

Audio file: marriage.webm · 214 words · about 1:32

Today's Question. What does God say about marriage?

Marriage is God's idea: two people joined as one for life, loving and serving each other as Christ loves his church.

From the first pages of the Bible, marriage is a man and woman leaving their parents and becoming one. Jesus affirmed it and said no one should separate what God has joined. The apostles call husbands and wives to put each other first, in the pattern of Christ's own self-giving love.

The Bible says, in Genesis chapter 2, verse 24: Therefore shall a man leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh.

And in Ephesians chapter 5, verse 21: Submitting yourselves one to another in the fear of God.

And in Proverbs chapter 18, verse 22: Whoso findeth a wife findeth a good thing, and obtaineth favour of the Lord.

Here is one thing to try. Ask your husband or wife one question this week: "What can I do to make your day easier?"

Let us pray. Lord, bless our marriage (or the marriage you have for me). Teach us to love each other as Christ loves us. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Parents and children

Audio file: parents-and-children.webm · 253 words · about 1:48

Today's Question. How should families treat each other?

Children are to honour their parents; parents are to teach, train and not provoke their children.

Honouring father and mother is the first commandment with a promise attached. Parents are given the task of passing on God's words in everyday life: at home, on the road, at bedtime and in the morning. Jesus welcomed children and said the kingdom belongs to them.

The Bible says, in Exodus chapter 20, verse 12: Honour thy father and thy mother: that thy days may be long upon the land which the Lord thy God giveth thee.

And in Proverbs chapter 22, verse 6: Train up a child in the way he should go: and when he is old, he will not depart from it.

And in Ephesians chapter 6, verses 1 to 4: Children, obey your parents in the Lord: for this is right. Honour thy father and mother; (which is the first commandment with promise;) That it may be well with thee, and thou mayest live long on the earth. And, ye fathers, provoke not your children to wrath: but bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.

Here is one thing to try. Share one thing God has done for you with your child or parent this week.

Let us pray. Lord, bless my family. Help us to honour and teach one another in your ways. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Friendship

Audio file: friendship.webm · 244 words · about 1:45

Today's Question. What makes a true friend?

A true friend loves at all times, tells the truth, and sticks closer than a brother. Choose friends who make you better.

Proverbs is full of friendship: loyal in hard times, honest enough to sharpen you, and better than going it alone. Jonathan and David show a friendship that put the other first. Jesus calls his disciples friends, and shows the greatest love a friend can give.

The Bible says, in John chapter 15, verses 13 to 15: Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends. Ye are my friends, if ye do whatsoever I command you. Henceforth I call you not servants; for the servant knoweth not what his lord doeth: but I have called you friends; for all things that I have heard of my Father I have made known unto you.

And in Proverbs chapter 17, verse 17: A friend loveth at all times, and a brother is born for adversity.

And in First Corinthians chapter 15, verse 33: Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners.

Here is one thing to try. Reach out to a friend who is going through something hard, and just be there.

Let us pray. Thank you, Jesus, for calling me your friend. Help me to be a faithful friend to others. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Loving your enemies

Audio file: loving-your-enemies.webm · 269 words · about 1:55

Today's Question. How do I treat people who are against me?

Don't repay evil with evil. Bless, pray for and do good to those who hate you, and overcome evil with good.

Jesus' command to love enemies was not new to the Law, which told Israel to return an enemy's straying ox. But he made it the mark of God's children. The apostles show how: don't take revenge, feed your enemy when he is hungry, and answer insults with blessing.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 5, verses 43 and 44: Ye have heard that it hath been said, Thou shalt love thy neighbour, and hate thine enemy. But I say unto you, Love your enemies, bless them that curse you, do good to them that hate you, and pray for them which despitefully use you, and persecute you;

And in Romans chapter 12, verses 20 and 21: Therefore if thine enemy hunger, feed him; if he thirst, give him drink: for in so doing thou shalt heap coals of fire on his head. Be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good.

And in Proverbs chapter 25, verse 21: If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat; and if he be thirsty, give him water to drink:

Here is one thing to try. Pray by name for someone who has hurt you, and ask God to bless them.

Let us pray. Lord Jesus, you prayed for your enemies. Soften my heart toward the people who are against me. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Words and the tongue

Audio file: words-and-the-tongue.webm · 254 words · about 1:49

Today's Question. Do my words really matter?

Words carry life and death. We will give account for them, so let them build up rather than tear down.

Jesus said we will answer for every careless word, and that a simple yes or no should be enough. James calls the tongue a small fire that can burn a forest. Proverbs puts it plainly: words can wound like a sword or heal like medicine.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 12, verses 36 and 37: But I say unto you, That every idle word that men shall speak, they shall give account thereof in the day of judgment. For by thy words thou shalt be justified, and by thy words thou shalt be condemned.

And in James chapter 3, verses 9 and 10: Therewith bless we God, even the Father; and therewith curse we men, which are made after the similitude of God. Out of the same mouth proceedeth blessing and cursing. My brethren, these things ought not so to be.

And in Proverbs chapter 18, verse 21: Death and life are in the power of the tongue: and they that love it shall eat the fruit thereof.

Here is one thing to try. For one day, say nothing about anyone that you wouldn't say to their face.

Let us pray. Set a watch, O LORD, before my mouth. Let my words today build up and not tear down. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Singleness

Audio file: singleness.webm · 328 words · about 2:21

Today's Question. Is being single second best?

No. Jesus and Paul both lived single lives, and Paul calls it a gift. Your worth and your family are found in Christ, married or not.

Many people feel that life only really begins at the wedding. The Bible disagrees. Jesus was never married, and he said some would stay single for the kingdom's sake. Paul, also single, called both marriage and singleness a 'proper gift of God', and said the unmarried can give undivided care to the Lord. Isaiah heard God promise a name 'better than of sons and of daughters' to those who hold fast to him. And Jesus said that all who do God's will are his brother, sister and mother.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 19, verses 11 and 12: But he said unto them, All men cannot receive this saying, save they to whom it is given. For there are some eunuchs, which were so born from their mother's womb: and there are some eunuchs, which were made eunuchs of men: and there be eunuchs, which have made themselves eunuchs for the kingdom of heaven's sake. He that is able to receive it, let him receive it.

And in First Corinthians chapter 7, verses 7 and 8: For I would that all men were even as I myself. But every man hath his proper gift of God, one after this manner, and another after that. I say therefore to the unmarried and widows, It is good for them if they abide even as I.

Here is one thing to try. If you are single, give one free hour this week to serving someone. If you are married, invite a single friend into your family's life.

Let us pray. Lord, you are my portion. Married or single, let my life be wholly yours, and set me in your family. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Work

Audio file: work.webm · 247 words · about 1:46

Today's Question. Does my work matter to God?

Work was part of God's good plan before the fall. Whatever you do, do it with all your heart, as for the Lord.

Before sin entered the world, God put Adam in the garden to work it and keep it. Work is not a curse but a calling. The Bible praises diligence and warns against idleness, and Paul tells even slaves to work 'heartily, as to the Lord', because he is the one who rewards.

The Bible says, in Genesis chapter 2, verse 15: And the Lord God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it.

And in Ecclesiastes chapter 9, verse 10: Whatsoever thy hand findeth to do, do it with thy might; for there is no work, nor device, nor knowledge, nor wisdom, in the grave, whither thou goest.

And in Colossians chapter 3, verses 23 and 24: And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men; Knowing that of the Lord ye shall receive the reward of the inheritance: for ye serve the Lord Christ.

Here is one thing to try. Before you start work tomorrow, offer it to God in one sentence.

Let us pray. Lord, my work belongs to you. Help me to do it well and honestly, as for you. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Money and possessions

Audio file: money-and-posessions.webm · 299 words · about 2:08

Today's Question. How should I think about money?

Money is a good servant and a terrible master. You cannot serve God and money.

Jesus spoke about money more than almost anything else, because it so easily takes God's place. Store up treasure in heaven, he said, because your heart follows your treasure. Paul warns that the love of money is a root of all kinds of evil, and tells the rich to be generous and hope in God, not in wealth.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 6, verses 19 to 21: Lay not up for yourselves treasures upon earth, where moth and rust doth corrupt, and where thieves break through and steal: But lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust doth corrupt, and where thieves do not break through nor steal: For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

And in First Timothy chapter 6, verse 10: For the love of money is the root of all evil: which while some coveted after, they have erred from the faith, and pierced themselves through with many sorrows.

And in Proverbs chapter 30, verses 8 and 9: Remove far from me vanity and lies: give me neither poverty nor riches; feed me with food convenient for me: Lest I be full, and deny thee, and say, Who is the Lord? or lest I be poor, and steal, and take the name of my God in vain.

Here is one thing to try. Look at where your money went last month. What does it say your heart treasures?

Let us pray. Lord, everything I have is yours. Keep me from loving money, and make me generous. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Generosity

Audio file: generosity.webm · 241 words · about 1:43

Today's Question. How much should I give?

Give freely, cheerfully and in proportion to what you have. God loves a cheerful giver, and no one out-gives him.

Jesus praised a widow who gave two small coins, because she gave all she had. The Law told Israel to open their hands wide to the poor and to bring the tithe. Paul says each should give as they have decided in their heart, not reluctantly, for God loves a cheerful giver.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 6, verse 38: Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom. For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again.

And in Second Corinthians chapter 9, verse 7: Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.

And in Proverbs chapter 19, verse 17: He that hath pity upon the poor lendeth unto the Lord; and that which he hath given will he pay him again.

Here is one thing to try. Give something away this week, quietly, to someone who cannot pay you back.

Let us pray. Generous God, you gave your Son for me. Make me a cheerful giver. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Honesty

Audio file: honesty.webm · 215 words · about 1:32

Today's Question. Is a small lie really a big deal?

Yes. God hates a false balance. Faithfulness in small things shows who we are in big ones.

The Law demanded honest weights and measures in the market. Proverbs says the one who walks in integrity walks securely. Jesus said that faithfulness in very little shows faithfulness in much, and the apostles tell believers to put away lying and speak the truth to one another.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 16, verse 10: He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in much: and he that is unjust in the least is unjust also in much.

And in Proverbs chapter 11, verse 1: A false balance is abomination to the Lord: but a just weight is his delight.

And in Ephesians chapter 4, verse 25: Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another.

Here is one thing to try. If you have shaded the truth somewhere, go and set it straight.

Let us pray. Lord of truth, make me honest in small things and large, when I am seen and when I am not. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Justice and the poor

Audio file: justice-and-the-poor.webm · 259 words · about 1:51

Today's Question. What does God expect me to do about injustice?

Do justly, love mercy, and speak up for those who cannot speak for themselves. Serving the least is serving Christ.

The prophets thundered against worship that ignored the poor, the widow and the orphan. The Law built care for the poor into farming itself. Jesus said that whatever we do for the least of his brothers, we do for him, and James calls caring for widows and orphans pure religion.

The Bible says, in Micah chapter 6, verse 8: He hath shewed thee, O man, what is good; and what doth the Lord require of thee, but to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God?

And in James chapter 1, verse 27: Pure religion and undefiled before God and the Father is this, To visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep himself unspotted from the world.

And in Proverbs chapter 31, verses 8 and 9: Open thy mouth for the dumb in the cause of all such as are appointed to destruction. Open thy mouth, judge righteously, and plead the cause of the poor and needy.

Here is one thing to try. Find one person or cause near you that speaks for the voiceless, and give your time or help.

Let us pray. Lord, open my eyes to the people I pass by. Teach me to do justly and love mercy. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Debt and borrowing

Audio file: debt-and-borrowing.webm · 245 words · about 1:45

Today's Question. Is it wrong to be in debt?

Borrowing is not a sin, but debt is a kind of servitude. Count the cost, pay what you owe, and let love be the only debt you keep.

The Bible does not forbid borrowing, but it is honest about what debt does: 'the borrower is servant to the lender'. Jesus told people to count the cost before they build, and to give back what is owed. Paul sums it up: owe nothing except love. And where others are in debt to us, the Law asks for mercy, not profit from the poor.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 14, verse 28: For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it?

And in Proverbs chapter 22, verse 7: The rich ruleth over the poor, and the borrower is servant to the lender.

And in Romans chapter 13, verse 8: Owe no man any thing, but to love one another: for he that loveth another hath fulfilled the law.

Here is one thing to try. Write down everything you owe, and make a plan to pay back one debt, however small.

Let us pray. Lord, keep me from being a slave to debt. Give me wisdom with money, and a heart that owes nothing but love. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Purpose

Audio file: purpose.webm · 235 words · about 1:41

Today's Question. What is my life for?

To know God, love him and enjoy him, and to do everything, even eating and drinking, to his glory.

The Preacher tried everything under the sun and concluded: fear God and keep his commandments. Jeremiah says the only thing worth boasting about is knowing God. Jesus came so that we might have life to the full, and Paul says that whatever we do, we can do it to the glory of God.

The Bible says, in John chapter 10, verse 10: The thief cometh not, but for to steal, and to kill, and to destroy: I am come that they might have life, and that they might have it more abundantly.

And in Ecclesiastes chapter 12, verse 13: Let us hear the conclusion of the whole matter: Fear God, and keep his commandments: for this is the whole duty of man.

And in First Corinthians chapter 10, verse 31: Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God.

Here is one thing to try. At the end of today, ask: where did I see God, and where did I show him to someone?

Let us pray. Lord, my life is yours. Let me know you, and let my light shine for your glory. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Prayer

Audio file: prayer.webm · 225 words · about 1:36

Today's Question. How should I pray?

Simply, honestly and often. Ask, seek and knock; God is near to all who call on him.

Jesus taught his disciples to pray in secret, not for show, and to keep asking without giving up. He promised that those who ask receive. The apostles say to pray without ceasing and in everything give thanks. The prophets and psalms promise that God is near and answers when we call.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 6, verse 6: But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.

And in First Thessalonians chapter 5, verses 17 and 18: Pray without ceasing. In every thing give thanks: for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning you.

And in Psalm 145, verse 18: The Lord is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth.

Here is one thing to try. Pray the Lord's Prayer slowly (Matthew chapter 6, verses 9 to 13), stopping on each line to make it your own.

Let us pray. Lord, teach me to pray. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Faith and trust

Audio file: faith-and-trust.webm · 296 words · about 2:07

Today's Question. How can I trust God when I can't see the way?

Faith is trusting God's word before you see the outcome. Lean on him, not on your own understanding.

Faith in the Bible is not a feeling but trust in a person. Proverbs says to trust the LORD with all your heart and he will make your paths straight. Habakkuk learned that 'the just shall live by his faith' in the worst of times, and Hebrews defines faith as confidence in what we hope for but cannot yet see.

The Bible says, in Mark chapter 11, verses 22 to 24: And Jesus answering saith unto them, Have faith in God. For verily I say unto you, That whosoever shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; and shall not doubt in his heart, but shall believe that those things which he saith shall come to pass; he shall have whatsoever he saith. Therefore I say unto you, What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them.

And in Proverbs chapter 3, verses 5 and 6: Trust in the Lord with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.

And in Hebrews chapter 11, verse 1: Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

Here is one thing to try. Write down one promise of God and one situation where you need to trust it today.

Let us pray. Lord, I trust you with what I cannot see. Direct my path. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Knowing God's will

Audio file: knowing-god-s-will.webm · 234 words · about 1:40

Today's Question. How do I know what God wants me to do?

Start with his word, ask for wisdom, listen to wise counsel, and obey what you already know.

God promises to guide those who seek him. His word is a lamp for the next step, not always a floodlight for the whole road. James promises wisdom to anyone who asks. Paul says a renewed mind learns to recognise God's good will, and Jesus says that willingness to do God's will comes before knowing it.

The Bible says, in John chapter 7, verse 17: If any man will do his will, he shall know of the doctrine, whether it be of God, or whether I speak of myself.

And in Psalm 119, verse 105: Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.

And in Romans chapter 12, verse 2: And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.

Here is one thing to try. Before a decision, pray, read, and ask one wise person you trust.

Let us pray. Lord, show me the way I should walk. I want to do your will; give me wisdom and light. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Rest

Audio file: rest.webm · 277 words · about 1:59

Today's Question. Is it all right to stop?

Yes. God rested, commanded rest, and invites the weary to come to him. Rest is a gift, not a weakness.

God rested on the seventh day and made the sabbath a gift for people who would otherwise never stop. Jesus took his tired disciples away to rest, and invited everyone who labours and is heavy laden to come to him. Stillness is where we learn again that he is God and we are not.

The Bible says, in Genesis chapter 2, verses 2 and 3: And on the seventh day God ended his work which he had made; and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had made. And God blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it: because that in it he had rested from all his work which God created and made.

And in Psalm 46, verse 10: Be still, and know that I am God: I will be exalted among the heathen, I will be exalted in the earth.

And in Isaiah chapter 30, verse 15: For thus saith the Lord God, the Holy One of Israel; In returning and rest shall ye be saved; in quietness and in confidence shall be your strength: and ye would not.

Here is one thing to try. Set aside one unhurried hour this week with no screen, and spend some of it with God.

Let us pray. Lord, I am tired. I come to you for rest. Teach me to be still and know that you are God. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Serving others

Audio file: serving-others.webm · 277 words · about 1:59

Today's Question. What does it mean to be great?

In God's kingdom the greatest is the servant. Jesus came not to be served, but to serve.

Jesus overturned every idea of greatness: the first will be the servant of all. He washed his disciples' feet and told them to do the same. Even Rehoboam's old advisers knew that a leader who serves his people is followed for ever. The apostles call every believer to use their gifts to serve one another in love.

The Bible says, in Mark chapter 10, verses 43 to 45: But so shall it not be among you: but whosoever will be great among you, shall be your minister: And whosoever of you will be the chiefest, shall be servant of all. For even the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many.

And in Galatians chapter 5, verse 13: For, brethren, ye have been called unto liberty; only use not liberty for an occasion to the flesh, but by love serve one another.

And in First Kings chapter 12, verse 7: And they spake unto him, saying, If thou wilt be a servant unto this people this day, and wilt serve them, and answer them, and speak good words to them, then they will be thy servants for ever.

Here is one thing to try. Look for the job nobody wants to do this week, and do it.

Let us pray. Lord Jesus, you came to serve. Give me a servant's heart. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Salvation

Audio file: salvation.webm · 309 words · about 2:12

Today's Question. How can I be right with God?

Not by being good enough, but by grace through faith. Jesus came to seek and to save the lost, and he turns no one away.

Most people ask what they must do to reach God. The Bible answers with what God has done to reach us. No one can earn their way back to him, but Christ died for us while we were still sinners. Abraham believed God, and it was counted to him for righteousness. The prophets promised that God would abundantly pardon all who return, and Jesus said that whoever comes to him will never be cast out. The apostles put it simply: 'Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved'.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 19, verse 10: For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost.

And in Isaiah chapter 55, verses 6 and 7: Seek ye the Lord while he may be found, call ye upon him while he is near: Let the wicked forsake his way, and the unrighteous man his thoughts: and let him return unto the Lord, and he will have mercy upon him; and to our God, for he will abundantly pardon.

And in Romans chapter 5, verse 8: But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.

Here is one thing to try. Read Romans chapter 10, verse 9. If you have never done it, tell God in your own words that you believe, and tell one person too.

Let us pray. Lord Jesus, I cannot save myself. I believe you died for me and rose again. Forgive me, and make me new. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Reading the Bible

Audio file: reading-the-bible.webm · 286 words · about 2:03

Today's Question. Why should I read the Bible?

Because it is God speaking. His word feeds the soul, lights the path and lasts for ever.

Jesus met temptation with 'It is written', and said the Scriptures point to him. Joshua was told to think on God's law day and night, and Jeremiah found God's words the joy of his heart. The apostles say that 'All scripture is given by inspiration of God', and that it is meant to change how we live: be doers of the word, not hearers only. Reading the Bible is how we come to know the God who speaks in it.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 11, verse 28: But he said, Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.

And in Jeremiah chapter 15, verse 16: Thy words were found, and I did eat them; and thy word was unto me the joy and rejoicing of mine heart: for I am called by thy name, O Lord God of hosts.

And in Second Timothy chapter 3, verses 16 and 17: All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness: That the man of God may be perfect, thoroughly furnished unto all good works.

Here is one thing to try. Pick one Gospel and read a short passage each day this week. Before you close it, ask: what does this show me about Jesus?

Let us pray. Lord, open my eyes to see wonderful things in your word, and help me to do what it says. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Church and fellowship

Audio file: church-and-fellowship.webm · 225 words · about 1:36

Today's Question. Do I need a church?

Following Jesus was never meant to be done alone. We are one body, and we need each other.

Jesus promised to be present where two or three gather in his name. The first believers devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching, fellowship, the breaking of bread and prayer. The apostles call the church the body of Christ, where every member matters, and warn against giving up meeting together. Church is not a building to visit, but a family to belong to.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 18, verse 20: For where two or three are gathered together in my name, there am I in the midst of them.

And in Psalm 133, verse 1: Behold, how good and how pleasant it is for brethren to dwell together in unity!

And in Acts chapter 2, verse 42: And they continued stedfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, and in breaking of bread, and in prayers.

Here is one thing to try. Go to church this week and learn one new person's name, or invite someone to come with you.

Let us pray. Lord, thank you for your family. Make me a faithful part of your body, and bind us together in love. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Thankfulness

Audio file: thankfulness.webm · 276 words · about 1:58

Today's Question. How can I be thankful when life is hard?

Give thanks in everything, not for everything. Thankfulness remembers what God has done and trusts him for what he will do.

Ten lepers were healed and only one came back to say thank you, and Jesus noticed. Jesus himself gave thanks at Lazarus' grave before he called him out. David told his own soul to forget not all God's benefits. Habakkuk chose to rejoice when the fig tree did not blossom, and Daniel gave thanks three times a day even when prayer had been forbidden. Paul writes, 'In every thing give thanks', because thankfulness is not a feeling but a choice to remember God.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 17, verses 17 and 18: And Jesus answering said, Were there not ten cleansed? but where are the nine? There are not found that returned to give glory to God, save this stranger.

And in Psalm 103, verses 1 and 2: Bless the Lord, O my soul: and all that is within me, bless his holy name. Bless the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits:

And in First Thessalonians chapter 5, verse 18: In every thing give thanks: for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning you.

Here is one thing to try. Each day this week, write down three things you can thank God for, even on a hard day.

Let us pray. Lord, you are good, and your mercy endures for ever. Teach me to give thanks in everything. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Suffering

Audio file: suffering.webm · 262 words · about 1:52

Today's Question. Why is this happening to me?

The Bible does not always answer why. It promises that God is with us in suffering, and that he works even this for good.

Jesus told his friends plainly that in this world they would have trouble, and to take heart because he has overcome the world. Job worshipped in his loss without knowing why. The apostles teach that suffering can grow patience and hope, that our troubles are light beside the glory coming, and that God works all things together for good for those who love him.

The Bible says, in John chapter 16, verse 33: These things I have spoken unto you, that in me ye might have peace. In the world ye shall have tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world.

And in Job chapter 1, verse 21: And said, Naked came I out of my mother's womb, and naked shall I return thither: the Lord gave, and the Lord hath taken away; blessed be the name of the Lord.

And in Romans chapter 8, verse 28: And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.

Here is one thing to try. Tell God honestly how you feel. The Psalms give you permission to lament.

Let us pray. Lord, I don't understand this. Be with me in it, and work even this for good. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Grief and loss

Audio file: grief-and-loss.webm · 241 words · about 1:43

Today's Question. How do I grieve as a believer?

Grieve honestly, as Jesus did. But not as those who have no hope.

Jesus wept at his friend's grave, though he knew he would raise him. Grief is not a lack of faith. The Bible gives a time to weep, promises that God is close to the broken-hearted, and that joy will come in the morning. Paul does not tell grieving believers not to sorrow, but not to sorrow without hope.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 5, verse 4: Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted.

And in Psalm 34, verse 18: The Lord is nigh unto them that are of a broken heart; and saveth such as be of a contrite spirit.

And in First Thessalonians chapter 4, verses 13 and 14: But I would not have you to be ignorant, brethren, concerning them which are asleep, that ye sorrow not, even as others which have no hope. For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him.

Here is one thing to try. Let yourself grieve. Share one memory with someone, and one hope with God.

Let us pray. Lord, you wept too. Stay close to my broken heart, and hold my hope when I cannot. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Discouragement and doubt

Audio file: discouragement-and-doubt.webm · 246 words · about 1:45

Today's Question. What do I do when I feel like giving up?

Even prophets despaired. God meets the weary with rest, fresh strength and mercies that are new every morning.

Elijah asked to die under a juniper tree, and God sent food and sleep before he sent new work. The Psalms talk honestly to a downcast soul. Thomas doubted, and Jesus came to him. The promise is not that we will never tire, but that God gives power to the faint and his mercies never run out.

The Bible says, in John chapter 20, verse 27: Then saith he to Thomas, reach hither thy finger, and behold my hands; and reach hither thy hand, and thrust it into my side: and be not faithless, but believing.

And in Psalm 42, verse 11: Why art thou cast down, O my soul? and why art thou disquieted within me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.

And in Galatians chapter 6, verse 9: And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.

Here is one thing to try. Eat, sleep and rest, then tell God honestly where you are.

Let us pray. Lord, I'm tired and my faith is small. Renew my strength, and help my unbelief. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Loneliness

Audio file: loneliness.webm · 267 words · about 1:54

Today's Question. What if I feel completely alone?

God has promised never to leave you or forsake you. He sets the lonely in families.

Moses told Israel, and later Joshua, that God would never fail or forsake them. David wrote that even if father and mother abandon us, the LORD takes us in. Paul, deserted by everyone at his trial, wrote that the Lord stood with him. And Jesus' last words in Matthew are a promise: I am with you always.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 28, verse 20: Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.

And in Psalm 27, verse 10: When my father and my mother forsake me, then the Lord will take me up.

And in Second Timothy chapter 4, verses 16 and 17: At my first answer no man stood with me, but all men forsook me: I pray God that it may not be laid to their charge. Notwithstanding the Lord stood with me, and strengthened me; that by me the preaching might be fully known, and that all the Gentiles might hear: and I was delivered out of the mouth of the lion.

Here is one thing to try. Reach out to one person today, even with a short message. Someone else may be lonely too.

Let us pray. Lord, you are with me even here. Set me in a family of your people. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Sickness and healing

Audio file: sickness-and-healing.webm · 346 words · about 2:28

Today's Question. Where is God when I'm sick?

He is near. God heals, and he gives grace to bear what is not yet healed. Pray, ask others to pray, and trust him with the outcome.

Jesus spent much of his ministry healing, and he reached out and touched a leper no one else would touch. God calls himself 'the LORD that healeth thee', and James tells the sick to call the elders to pray. Yet Paul prayed three times for his thorn to be taken away and was told, 'My grace is sufficient for thee'. Healing may come now or in the life to come; either way, God does not leave the sick alone.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 8, verses 2 and 3: And, behold, there came a leper and worshipped him, saying, Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean. And Jesus put forth his hand, and touched him, saying, I will; be thou clean. And immediately his leprosy was cleansed.

And in James chapter 5, verses 14 and 15: Is any sick among you? let him call for the elders of the church; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord: And the prayer of faith shall save the sick, and the Lord shall raise him up; and if he have committed sins, they shall be forgiven him.

And in Second Corinthians chapter 12, verse 9: And he said unto me, My grace is sufficient for thee: for my strength is made perfect in weakness. Most gladly therefore will I rather glory in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me.

Here is one thing to try. If you are sick, ask someone to pray with you. If you are well, visit or call someone who is sick.

Let us pray. Lord, you are the one who heals. Touch my body, or give me grace to bear what I must. I trust you. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Guilt and shame

Audio file: guilt-and-shame.webm · 328 words · about 2:21

Today's Question. Can God forgive what I've done?

Yes. No sin is too big for his mercy. Confess it, and he forgives and cleanses, and removes it as far as the east is from the west.

Guilt is real, and Scripture does not pretend otherwise. But David, who had committed adultery and murder, wrote that when he confessed, God forgave. Isaiah heard God promise that sins like scarlet could be made white as snow. Jesus told of a son who wasted everything and a father who ran to meet him, and said to a woman caught in sin, 'Neither do I condemn thee: go, and sin no more'. The apostles say that if we confess, he is faithful and just to forgive.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 15, verses 20 to 22: And he arose, and came to his father. But when he was yet a great way off, his father saw him, and had compassion, and ran, and fell on his neck, and kissed him. And the son said unto him, Father, I have sinned against heaven, and in thy sight, and am no more worthy to be called thy son. But the father said to his servants, Bring forth the best robe, and put it on him; and put a ring on his hand, and shoes on his feet:

And in First John chapter 1, verse 9: If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

Here is one thing to try. Tell God plainly what you did, then read First John chapter 1, verse 9 and believe it. If you need to put it right with someone, do that too.

Let us pray. Have mercy on me, O God. Wash me and make me clean, and help me to believe that I am forgiven. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Failure

Audio file: failure.webm · 301 words · about 2:09

Today's Question. Can I start again after I've failed?

Yes. The righteous fall and rise again, and Jesus restored even the friend who denied him.

Peter swore he would never deny Jesus, and then did, three times. Jesus had already prayed for him, and after the resurrection asked him three times, 'lovest thou me?', and gave him work to do again. Jonah ran from God, and the word of the LORD came to him a second time. Proverbs says a just man falls seven times and rises up again. Paul, who once persecuted the church, learned to forget what was behind and press on.

The Bible says, in Luke chapter 22, verses 31 and 32: And the Lord said, Simon, Simon, behold, Satan hath desired to have you, that he may sift you as wheat: But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and when thou art converted, strengthen thy brethren.

And in Proverbs chapter 24, verse 16: For a just man falleth seven times, and riseth up again: but the wicked shall fall into mischief.

And in Philippians chapter 3, verses 13 and 14: Brethren, I count not myself to have apprehended: but this one thing I do, forgetting those things which are behind, and reaching forth unto those things which are before, I press toward the mark for the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus.

Here is one thing to try. Name one failure you keep replaying. Give it to God, learn one lesson from it, and take one step forward.

Let us pray. Lord, I have failed. Thank you that your mercies are new. Lift me up, and let me begin again with you. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Waiting

Audio file: waiting.webm · 273 words · about 1:57

Today's Question. Why is God taking so long?

God's timing is not ours, but he is never late. Waiting is not wasted time.

Abraham and Sarah waited decades for a son, and he came 'at the set time'. When Jesus heard that Lazarus was sick, he stayed where he was two more days, because he meant to do something greater than a healing. David waited patiently and was heard. Habakkuk was told that what God had shown him would come, 'though it tarry'. James points to the farmer who waits patiently for the rain.

The Bible says, in Acts chapter 1, verse 7: And he said unto them, It is not for you to know the times or the seasons, which the Father hath put in his own power.

And in Psalm 40, verse 1: I waited patiently for the Lord; and he inclined unto me, and heard my cry.

And in James chapter 5, verses 7 and 8: Be patient therefore, brethren, unto the coming of the Lord. Behold, the husbandman waiteth for the precious fruit of the earth, and hath long patience for it, until he receive the early and latter rain. Be ye also patient; stablish your hearts: for the coming of the Lord draweth nigh.

Here is one thing to try. Write down what you are waiting for. Beside it, write one thing you can do faithfully while you wait.

Let us pray. Lord, I don't understand your timing, but I trust your heart. Teach me to wait on you with hope. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Standing for your faith

Audio file: standing-for-your-faith.webm · 330 words · about 2:21

Today's Question. What if people mock me for my faith?

Jesus said it would happen, and called those who suffer for him blessed. Don't be ashamed, don't hit back, and remember that nothing can separate you from his love.

Jesus warned his followers that the world would hate them as it hated him, and told them to rejoice, because the prophets were treated the same way. Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego refused to bow even if God did not rescue them. Stephen died praying for the men who stoned him. Paul asks, 'Who shall separate us from the love of Christ?', and answers that in all these things we are more than conquerors.

The Bible says, in Matthew chapter 5, verses 10 to 12: Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake. Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you.

And in Psalm 56, verse 4: In God I will praise his word, in God I have put my trust; I will not fear what flesh can do unto me.

And in Acts chapter 7, verses 59 and 60: And they stoned Stephen, calling upon God, and saying, Lord Jesus, receive my spirit. And he kneeled down, and cried with a loud voice, Lord, lay not this sin to their charge. And when he had said this, he fell asleep.

Here is one thing to try. Pray by name for someone who mocks your faith, and answer them this week with kindness, not argument.

Let us pray. Lord Jesus, you were despised for my sake. Keep me faithful and unashamed, and help me to bless those who mock. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Hope

Audio file: hope.webm · 247 words · about 1:46

Today's Question. Is there hope for my future?

Yes. God has plans for his people, and a living hope kept in heaven that nothing can spoil.

Jeremiah wrote to exiles far from home that God's thoughts toward them were of peace, to give them a future. The apostles call Christian hope 'lively', alive because Jesus rose, and an anchor for the soul. Hope in the Bible is not wishful thinking but confident waiting on a faithful God.

The Bible says, in Jeremiah chapter 29, verse 11: For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, saith the Lord, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you an expected end.

And in Psalm 39, verse 7: And now, Lord, what wait I for? my hope is in thee.

And in First Peter chapter 1, verses 3 and 4: Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, which according to his abundant mercy hath begotten us again unto a lively hope by the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, To an inheritance incorruptible, and undefiled, and that fadeth not away, reserved in heaven for you,

Here is one thing to try. Write down one fear about the future, and next to it one promise of God.

Let us pray. God of hope, fill me with joy and peace as I trust you with my future. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Growing old

Audio file: growing-old.webm · 284 words · about 2:02

Today's Question. What does God say about growing old?

Old age is not the end of usefulness. God carries his people to grey hairs, and the old still bear fruit.

God promised his people, 'even to hoar hairs will I carry you'. Caleb was eighty-five and still ready to take a mountain. Anna, at a great age, served God night and day and was among the first to speak of the child Jesus. The psalmists pray not to be cast off when strength fails, but to live to tell the next generation what God has done. Paul says that though the body wears out, the inner person is renewed day by day.

The Bible says, in Isaiah chapter 46, verse 4: And even to your old age I am he; and even to hoar hairs will I carry you: I have made, and I will bear; even I will carry, and will deliver you.

And in Psalm 92, verse 14: They shall still bring forth fruit in old age; they shall be fat and flourishing;

And in Second Corinthians chapter 4, verse 16: For which cause we faint not; but though our outward man perish, yet the inward man is renewed day by day.

Here is one thing to try. If you are older, tell a younger person one thing God has done for you. If you are younger, ask an older believer for their story.

Let us pray. Lord, you have carried me this far. Carry me to the end, and let me bear fruit and tell of your goodness to those who come after me. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Death and eternal life

Audio file: death-and-eternal-life.webm · 284 words · about 2:02

Today's Question. What happens when we die?

For those who trust Christ, death is not the end. Whoever believes in him has everlasting life and will be raised.

Job believed that his Redeemer lives and that he would see God. Daniel foresaw the dead awaking. Jesus promised everlasting life to all who believe, called himself the resurrection and the life, and said he was preparing a place for his people. Paul could say that to die is gain, because death has lost its sting.

The Bible says, in John chapter 3, verse 16: For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.

And in Job chapter 19, verses 25 and 26: For I know that my redeemer liveth, and that he shall stand at the latter day upon the earth: And though after my skin worms destroy this body, yet in my flesh shall I see God:

And in First Corinthians chapter 15, verses 54 and 55: So when this corruptible shall have put on incorruption, and this mortal shall have put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written, Death is swallowed up in victory. O death, where is thy sting? O grave, where is thy victory?

Here is one thing to try. Read John chapter 11, verses 25 and 26 and answer Jesus' question to Martha for yourself: 'Believest thou this?'

Let us pray. Lord Jesus, you are the resurrection and the life. I put my trust in you, in life and in death. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

The return of Christ

Audio file: the-return-of-christ.webm · 327 words · about 2:20

Today's Question. Is Jesus really coming back?

Yes. No one knows the day or hour, so live ready: watching, working and waiting.

Daniel saw one like the Son of man coming with the clouds of heaven. Jesus promised to come again and warned that no one knows when, so we should be ready. The apostles waited eagerly for him, explained that his delay is God's patience, giving time to repent, and ended the Bible with a prayer: come, Lord Jesus.

The Bible says, in John chapter 14, verse 3: And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and receive you unto myself; that where I am, there ye may be also.

And in Daniel chapter 7, verses 13 and 14: I saw in the night visions, and, behold, one like the Son of man came with the clouds of heaven, and came to the Ancient of days, and they brought him near before him. And there was given him dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all people, nations, and languages, should serve him: his dominion is an everlasting dominion, which shall not pass away, and his kingdom that which shall not be destroyed.

And in First Thessalonians chapter 4, verses 16 and 17: For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God: and the dead in Christ shall rise first: Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord.

Here is one thing to try. If Jesus came back tomorrow, what would you want to have put right today?

Let us pray. Even so, come, Lord Jesus. Keep me ready and faithful until you do. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

Judgement

Audio file: judgement.webm · 307 words · about 2:12

Today's Question. Will I have to answer for my life?

Everyone will give account to God. But whoever trusts Christ has passed from death to life and does not come into condemnation.

The Preacher ends by reminding us that God will bring every work into judgement. Jesus spoke of the Son of man separating the nations, and the apostles say we will each give account of ourselves. But Jesus also promised that whoever hears his word and believes will not come into condemnation. Judgement is real, and so is mercy.

The Bible says, in Ecclesiastes chapter 12, verses 13 and 14: Let us hear the conclusion of the whole matter: Fear God, and keep his commandments: for this is the whole duty of man. For God shall bring every work into judgment, with every secret thing, whether it be good, or whether it be evil.

And in Matthew chapter 25, verses 31 and 32: When the Son of man shall come in his glory, and all the holy angels with him, then shall he sit upon the throne of his glory: And before him shall be gathered all nations: and he shall separate them one from another, as a shepherd divideth his sheep from the goats:

And in Second Corinthians chapter 5, verse 10: For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ; that every one may receive the things done in his body, according to that he hath done, whether it be good or bad.

Here is one thing to try. Live today as someone who will give account, and who is already forgiven.

Let us pray. Lord, I will stand before you one day. Thank you that in Christ I have passed from death to life. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.

All things new

Audio file: all-things-new.webm · 230 words · about 1:39

Today's Question. How does the story end?

With a new heaven and a new earth, where God lives with his people, and there is no more death, crying or pain.

The prophets saw a coming world with no more war, where the wolf lies down with the lamb and the earth is full of the knowledge of God. Jesus taught us to pray for that kingdom to come on earth as in heaven. The Bible ends where it began, in a garden city, with God wiping every tear away and saying, 'Behold, I make all things new.'

The Bible says, in Isaiah chapter 65, verse 17: For, behold, I create new heavens and a new earth: and the former shall not be remembered, nor come into mind.

And in Matthew chapter 6, verse 10: Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.

And in Second Peter chapter 3, verse 13: Nevertheless we, according to his promise, look for new heavens and a new earth, wherein dwelleth righteousness.

Here is one thing to try. Do one thing this week that looks like the world to come: make peace, heal, or give.

Let us pray. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Amen.

You can read every passage on this question in Questions We All Ask, in Daily Grace.